Application guide

GSTP De-Risk, Building Blocks, and Element 2 Call in Spain

Spanish Space Technology Call 2024

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GOBIERNO DE ESPAÑA
MINISTERIO DE DEFENSA
MINISTERIO DE CIENCIA, INNOVACIÓN Y UNIVERSIDADES
AGENCIA ESPACIAL ESPAÑOLA

esa

GSTP De-Risk, Building Blocks, and Element 2 Call in Spain

In this document, you will find information about the Spanish Space Technology Call 2024 for funding from the European Space Agency (ESA) General Support technology Programme (GSTP).

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1. What can I apply for?

In the GSTP Spanish Space Technology Call 2024, the Agencia Espacial Española (hereafter: AEE) has allocated up to 15 M€ to support Spanish entities' (companies and research institutions) space related activities.

The purpose of the call is to build and expand space technology capabilities in Spain and strengthen the competitiveness of the Spanish space industry in the European and global space market.

The call is targeting generic space technology developments addressing any of the following application domains: Earth observation, science, exploration, human spaceflight, space safety, space transportation, navigation or generic technologies. In addition, the call has a dedicated category (see Category 2) for technologies targeting Lunar Exploration.

It is not a requirement that the activity covers all phases of a project. However, additional funding cannot be guaranteed at this time and will be subject to a new call.

The proposed work shall not overlap with any previous or presently running ESA or National activities awarded to any entity in the Proposed Team.

In 2024, the Call is divided into three categories:

- **Category 1: GSTP Element 1 De-Risk Technology Framework** is dedicated towards industry driven activities that are preparing and de-risking innovative technology developments and reducing the risk associated to them.

  In the GSTP Element 1 De-Risk Framework, **activities between 100 K€ and 250 K€ may be proposed.**

  A maximum ESA budget of 1.5 M€ will be allocated to this category.

  Read more about the De-Risk Framework in section 4.

- **Category 2: GSTP Element 1 Building Blocks Framework - Technologies for Lunar Exploration** is dedicated towards industry driven activities to develop enabling capabilities and the associated building blocks for space related systems and the associated sub-systems with the targeted applications for Lunar Exploration.

  In the GSTP Element 1 Building Blocks for Lunar Exploration, **activities between 200 K€ and 1,000 K€ may be proposed.**

  A maximum ESA budget of 5 M€ will be allocated to this category.

  Read more about the Building Blocks Framework for Lunar Exploration in section 4.

- **Category 3: GSTP Element 2** is dedicated towards industry driven co-funded activities enabling the development of technologies and products for market competitiveness and sustainability.

  In the GSTP Element 2, **activities between 200 K€ (total budget) and 1,500 K€ (ESA funding) may be proposed.**

  Activities proposed in this category are required to be co-funded by the Tenderer with a minimum of 50% of the total budget.

  A maximum ESA budget 8.5 M€ will be allocated to this category.

  Read more about Element 2 in section 4.

Read more about ESA's GSTP programme here.

If in one of the categories: GSTP De-risk Technology, Building Blocks for Lunar Exploration or Element 2, the ESA budget is not fully allocated, the remaining budget could be allocated in any of the other categories.

Note: On 3rd September 2024 an information session has been hosted by AEE and ESA. The info session included:

- Introduction to the General Support Technology Programme (GSTP).
- Information about the GSTP Spanish Space Technology Call 2024.

2. Who can apply?

To apply for funding from the GSTP Spanish Space Technology Call 2024, applicants must meet the following eligibility requirements:

- The applicant entity (company or institution) must be registered in Spain.
- In case of cooperation with entities in other GSTP Participating States, the applicant portion of the activity must take place in Spain.

In addition, the applicant entity shall comply with the Special Conditions for the submission of the Outline Proposal (see page 10).

Applicants should be registered in **esa-star** for the last steps of the application process. It is highly encouraged to do this early. If applicant is not already registered in esa-star, please use the following link:
https://www.esa.int/About_Us/Business_with_ESA/How_to_do/esa-star_registration_process

3. Timeline and planning

GSTP Element 1 De-Risk and Element 2 Call in Spain timeline and planning.

Date	Description	Who
3rd September 2024	GSTP De-Risk, Building Blocks & Element 2 Call Information Session	ESA / AEE / Entities
15th September	Application guide published in website	AEE
15th September 2024	**Launch of the De-Risk, Building Blocks and Element 2 Call in Spain**	
~~28th October 2024~~ 18th November 2024	**Submission of outline proposal deadline**	**Entities**
end January 2025	Publication of the pre-selected activity list on the AEE website.	AEE
February 2025	Technical discussion meetings (teleconference)	ESA (Organiser) / Pre-selected Entities
March/April -2025	Official ESA- Request for full proposal (RFP)	ESA
April/May-2025	**Submission of full proposal in esa-star**	**Entities**
June/July - 2025	Negotiation meetings	ESA/Entities
Q3 2025	**Kick-off**	**ESA/Entities**

(The timeline is tentative and subject to change depending in particular on the number of proposals received and subject to evaluation and the duration of the technical discussions after the preselection.)

4. Call categories

GSTP Element 1 – De-Risk Technology Framework

GSTP Element 1 De-Risk Framework is dedicated to preparing and de-risking innovative technology developments and to reduce the risk associated to them. During the activity potential added value of the development and the critical issues will be addressed. The results of these activities are intended to help orienting a follow-on development activity.

In particular, the following tasks are expected to be considered in the activities under this category:

- Identification and analysis of specifications for one or more space applications and the technical assessment of the development actions and associated schedule and cost.
- Assessment of the potential benefits (performance, cost, lead time, risks…) and disadvantages of the potential solution with respect to the state-of-the-art.
- Assessment of potential critical issues related to using a given technology for a specific application, using analysis/simulation and/or breadboarding and testing.

The starting Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of the proposed technology to be developed is expected to be 3 or above at the start of the technology development activity and targeting TRL 4 or above at the end of the activity.

GSTP Element 1 Building Blocks Framework – Technologies for Lunar Exploration

GSTP Element 1 Building Blocks Framework - Technologies for Lunar Exploration is dedicated towards industry driven activities to develop enabling capabilities and the associated building blocks for space related systems and the associated sub-systems with the targeted applications for Lunar Exploration.

This category is focused specifically on the technologies for Lunar Exploration. This includes development of technologies, building blocks, components and test beds for projects for future Lunar missions. Including Platform, Payload, Ground Segment and Engineering tools.
The results are intended to provide industry with a stronger foundation (i.e. building on this acquired know-how) in order to contribute to Lunar Exploration related system opportunities at national or international levels (institutional, commercial…).

The developments proposed may start from a proof-of-concept (via simulation or experiment) up to an engineering qualification model (EQM).

The starting Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of the proposed technology to be developed is expected to be 3 or above at the start of the technology development activity and targeting TRL 5 or above at the end of the activity.

GSTP Element 2

GSTP Element 2 is dedicated towards industry driven co-funded activities enabling the development of technologies and products for market competitiveness and sustainability.

Industry is invited to submit proposals addressing one of the two technology and product development segments:

- Segment 1: Market oriented opportunities
- Segment 2: Strategic opportunities

What are the Segments?

- **Segment 1: "Market Oriented Opportunities":** Activities submitted in the frame of Segment 1 should address the development of new products or improvements of existing products for well-defined markets. The specific business opportunities should be clearly defined, along with the potential customers. In this segment, the Tenderers should provide a mature business plan.
  Companies submitting proposals in this segment should have a background in commercialising technologies in the space markets.

- **Segment 2: "Strategic Opportunities":** These activities should address cases that are commercially strategic from a market or an industrial (i.e. value chain/production process) perspective:
  - Strategic market goals include access to new applications/markets that have indirect commercial impact (i.e. they do not bring a direct commercial return but enhance the competitiveness, for example via a high-profile application/ market or by achieving market diversity to reduce market dependence). For these goals, the business opportunity should be well defined. They may also include entry into a new market, where the company needs to develop, manufacture and test a breadboard or engineering model in order to attract interest and obtain detailed requirements from possible customers.
  - Strategic industrial (i.e. value chain/production process) goals pertain to companies that have established products or technologies serving a given market. These companies may, for instance, address obsolescence issues in the supply chain, apply new manufacturing techniques or develop an alternative (possibly internal) capability in order to replace an external source.

<u>NOTE</u>: In the outline proposal template, please fill in only the part for the selected segment you apply.

The starting Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of the proposed technology to be developed is expected to be 3 or above at the start of the technology development activity and targeting TRL 5 or above at the end of the activity.

5. Conditions and the Process

How much can I apply for?

Category 1 – De-risk

Technology development **activities between 100 K€ and 250 K€** may be proposed in this category.

The activities will be fully funded.

The **maximum duration** of the activity cannot exceed **9 months.**

Category 2 – Building Blocks - Technologies for Lunar Exploration

Technology development **activities for Lunar exploration between 200 K€ and 1,000 K€** may be proposed in this category.

The activities will be fully funded.

The **expected duration** of this activities is **no more than 24 months**.

Category 3 – Element 2

For the Market oriented activities there is **no budget difference between segments: activities between 200 K€ (total budget) and 1,500 K€ (ESA funding)** may be proposed in both segments.

Activities proposed in this category **are required to be co-funded by the Tenderer with a minimum of 50% of the total budget.** This requirement is mandatory and exception to the standard conditions of Element 2[1]. This requirement applies to all entities participating in the consortium.

Universities and research institutes are invited to support industry driven developments; however their participation shall be limited to 30% of the overall effort. Under this Element, universities and research institutes are not eligible to lead a consortium as Prime Contractors.

The **expected duration** of this activities is **no more than 24 months.**

How do I apply?

The application process for a GSTP Element 1 De-Risk, Building Blocks and Element 2 activities is as follows:

- **Step 1:** Ensure you're registered in esa-star.
- **Step 2:** Submit an Outline Proposal to selected channel (OSIP Channel GSTP De-Risk, OSIP Channel GSTP Building Blocks, or OSIP Channel GSTP Element 2) in OSIP (Open Space Innovation Platform) before the ~~**ESA deadline: 28th October 2024**~~**. Extended ESA deadline: 18th November 2024.**
- **Step 3:** ESA and the AEE evaluates received Outline Proposals and pre-selects the activities to be supported.
- **Step 4:** Successful applicants will receive a Letter of Support from the AEE for their activities and will be invited to submit a Full Proposal to ESA, through esa-star.

[1] The co-funding condition of 50% of the total budget supersedes the standard E2 co-funding conditions. The co-funding table in the OSIP channel does not apply in this Call.

Step 1: Ensure you're registered in esa-star

Please note that a pre-requisite for submitting any technology development proposal to GSTP, is to have completed the on-line dedicated questionnaire for being registered in esa-star as an entity wishing to do business with ESA.

"esa-star registration" website:
https://esastar-emr.sso.esa.int/

esa-star Registration User Manual:
https://esastar-emr.sso.esa.int/Account/DownloadFile

Please note that only the "Full Registration" allows the Contract to be placed with the selected Tenderer.

Step 2: Submit an Outline Proposal to De-Risk, Building Blocks, or Element 2 in OSIP

- The deadline for submitting an Outline Proposal to ESA is ~~**28th October 2024**~~ **Extended ESA deadline: 18th November 2024.**

On ESA's GSTP **De-Risk, Building Blocks,** and **Element 2** channels in the OSIP website (see the links below), you can find descriptions of the GSTP E1 De-Risk, Building Blocks and Element 2, as well as outline proposal templates, requirements, and evaluation criteria for ESA's application process. Please note that the instructions in this document supersede the instructions in the channels in OSIP.

Links to the channels:

De-Risk Channel in OSIP:
https://ideas.esa.int/servlet/hype/IMT?documentTableId=45087183940304259&userAction=Browse&templateName=&documentId=a19fe43cb577173800397fa26cdc1431

Building Blocks Channel in OSIP:
https://ideas.esa.int/servlet/hype/IMT?documentTableId=45087196634267531&userAction=Browse&templateName=&documentId=359c6b6c83a35aa99c59cd19e002e833

Element 2 Channel in OSIP:
https://ideas.esa.int/servlet/hype/IMT?documentTableId=45087192129392599&userAction=Browse&templateName=&documentId=d1b0bbb26bfd9c41bd3d3e4471325c40

Applicants must apply through the selected GSTP **De-Risk, Building Blocks,** or **Element 2** application process, where a company/institution submits its activity proposal. The

application is called **Outline Proposal**.
To submit your Outline Proposal, click *"Submit Your Idea"* at the top of the GSTP **De-Risk**, **Building Blocks,** or **Element 2** Channel webpage.

Special Conditions for the submission of the Outline Proposal:

- For all Call Categories, the additional requested documents indicated in the *Annex 1 - Additional requested documents* of this guidelines shall be submitted in the corresponding channel together with the Outline Proposal, preferably in one single separate pdf.
- For all Call Categories an additional sub-chapter addressing the Impact for the Spanish Space Sector shall be included in the outline proposal following the guidelines in the *Annex 2*.
- For Element 2 activities, the outline proposal shall include the work logic as well as the detailed work package descriptions in the Part B (Technical Proposal) - Chapter 3 – Development Plan, Deliverables and Schedule of the Outline proposal.
- For all Call Categories, detailed costing information shall be provided in the outline, in particular PSS A8. Exhibit A shall be also provided in case of significant funding dedicated to procurements. (PSS forms: https://esastar-publication-ext.sso.esa.int/supportingDocumentation/details/18)

Step 3: Outline Proposals Evaluation

After the deadline for submitting Outline Proposals, ESA and the AEE evaluates all proposals based on the **De-Risk, Building Blocks,** or **Element 2** evaluation criteria depending on the category applied. Evaluation criteria can be found in the Annex 3. In broad terms, the proposals will be evaluated on the following aspects:

De-Risk outline proposal evaluation criteria:

- **Criteria 1. Technical and Implementation Proposal**: Clear and credible definition of the technical objectives, key requirements, technical steps, and risks to be addressed in this activity.
- **Criteria 2. Innovation, Application and Impact assessment of the proposed development:** Clear indication of the application and potential users of the technology **including Impact on Spanish Space Sector.**
- **Criteria 3. Management Considerations and Financial Overview:** Clarity of the management approach and adequacy of the proposed costs with the work to be performed.
- **Criteria 4. Cost to Completion:** Clear information about Cost to Completion including the Follow-on activities.

Building Blocks – Technologies for Lunar Exploration outline proposal evaluation criteria:

- **Criteria 1. Technical and Implementation Proposal**: Clear and credible definition of the technical objectives, key requirements, technical steps and risks to be addressed in this activity.
- **Criteria 2. Innovation, Application and Impact assessment of the proposed development:** Clear indication of the application and potential users of the technology **including Impact on Spanish Space Sector.**

- **Criteria 3. Management Considerations and Financial Overview:** Clarity of the management approach and the adequacy of the proposed costs with the work to be performed in the Building Block activity.

Element 2 outline proposal evaluation criteria:

- **Criteria 1. Market Context, Business/Strategic Opportunity and Impact assessment:** Clarity and credibility of the market context and business opportunity (for segment 1) or strategic opportunity (for segment 2). **Including Impact on Spanish Space Sector (for both Segment 1 and 2).**
- **Criteria 2. Technical Proposal:** Credibility and quality of the technical requirements, technical solutions versus activity objectives.
- **Criteria 3. Implementation Proposal:** Credibility and quality of the proposed development plan, deliverables and schedule.
- **Criteria 4. Management Considerations:** Credibility and quality of the bidder's background, experience and facilities.
- **Criteria 5. Financial Overview:** Credibility and quality of the cost breakdown by cost elements and cost by funding source.

The evaluation and selection is conducted by ESA and the AEE. The final decision is made based on the process described in this document.

AEE will publish the list of selected proposals in the AEE web site. For selected proposals recommendations for improvement may be provided and shall be considered in the preparation of the full proposal.

AEE will submit Letters of support to ESA for the selected applicants.

After the provision of Letters of Support, the AEE is no longer involved in the application process and contract negotiation.

Step 4: Submit Full Proposal to ESA

Applicant entities that submitted GSTP **De-Risk**, **Building Blocks**, or **Element 2** Outline Proposals which have been positively evaluated will receive an invitation from ESA to submit a Full Proposal following the ESA Star process: **De-Risk** (Link here), **Building Blocks** (link here) or **Element 2** (Link here).

The Full proposal builds on the outline proposal taking into consideration the previous recommendations.

In the event of a successful evaluation of the Full Proposal, ESA and the applicant engage in negotiations to finalize a contract.

6. Agencia Espacial Española (AEE): Contact Information

The GSTP Spanish Space Technology Call 2024 is managed by ESA and the Agencia Espacial Española (AEE).

If you have any questions concerning the call, you are welcome to contact the AEE for clarification. Potential applicants who have no previous experience with the application process at ESA are encouraged to contact the AEE for guidance.

Please contact **gstp@aee.gob.es** if you need advice.

7. Annex 1: Additional requested documents

Documents requested in this Annex 2 can be provided in Spanish.

Applicant entities are requested to provide:

- The signed subcontracts or cooperation agreements or letters confirming the terms of the cooperation with the consortium members or subcontractors.

- Any existing documentation showing reliably an interest of future customers or collaborations either for acquiring / exploiting the developed technologies or for exploiting scientifically the outputs of the project.

- Certified Statement for the main proposer and each consortium member who would directly receive funding if this activity justifying that:

    - The entities have not filed for bankruptcy and have not been declared insolvent

    - Are up to date with payments and comply with obligations regarding Taxes and Social Security, as imposed by current Spanish Regulations

    - Are not in situation of delinquency with respect the Spanish Administration and ESA

    - Are not already receiving public funding for the development tasks object of the present proposal.

These additional requested documents shall be provided in the corresponding OSIP channel together with the submission of the outline proposal.

8. Annex 2: Spanish Space Technology Call specific criteria – Impact Assessment on the Spanish Space Sector

Annex 2 indicates Spanish Space Technology Call specific criteria that will be assessed in the Outline Proposal.

Impact Assessment on the Spanish Space Sector criteria:

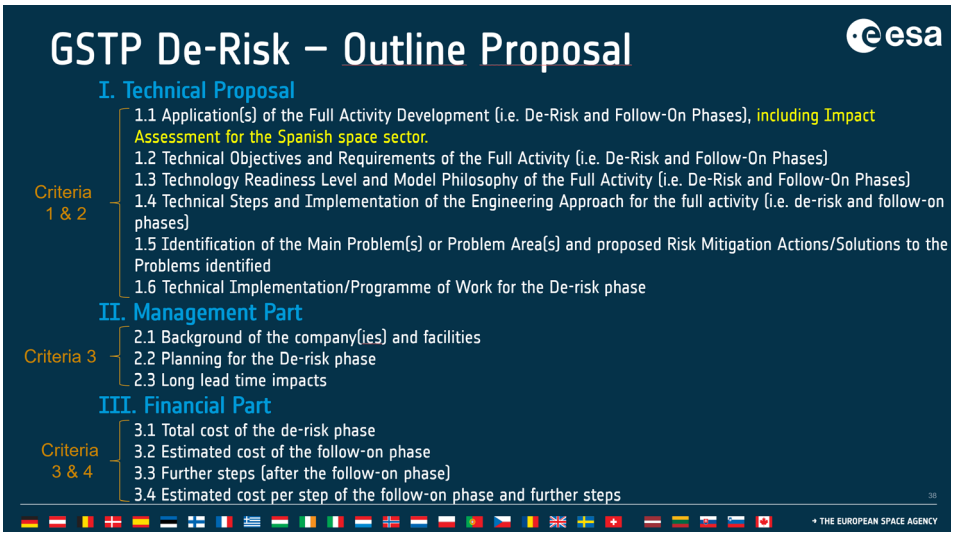
- **Return on Investment for Spain:** The financial return for the Spanish space sector must be clearly demonstrated.
- **Leadership Potential:** The potential of the proposal to grant Spain a leadership role in missions or in the development of instruments will be assessed.
- **Competitiveness of the Spanish Industry:** demonstrate an increase in market options and position of Spain in the international arena.
- **Consistency with Strategic Objectives:** aligned with the company's strategic plan, as well as with the objectives of the Spanish space policy.

Priority will be given to those proposals that demonstrate a greater impact for the Spanish space sector, which position Spain in a leadership role.

This information is mandatory to be provided in the Outline Proposal in the following chapters:

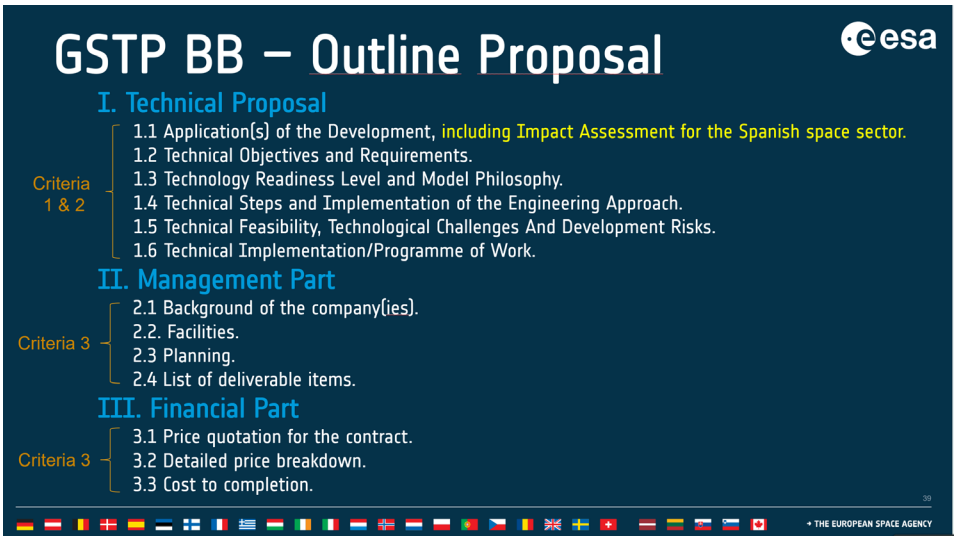
Category 1: GSTP Element 1 De-Risk Technology Framework

- Technical Proposal
- Chapter 1.1 Application(s) of the Full Activity Development (i.e. De-Risk and Follow-On Phases)



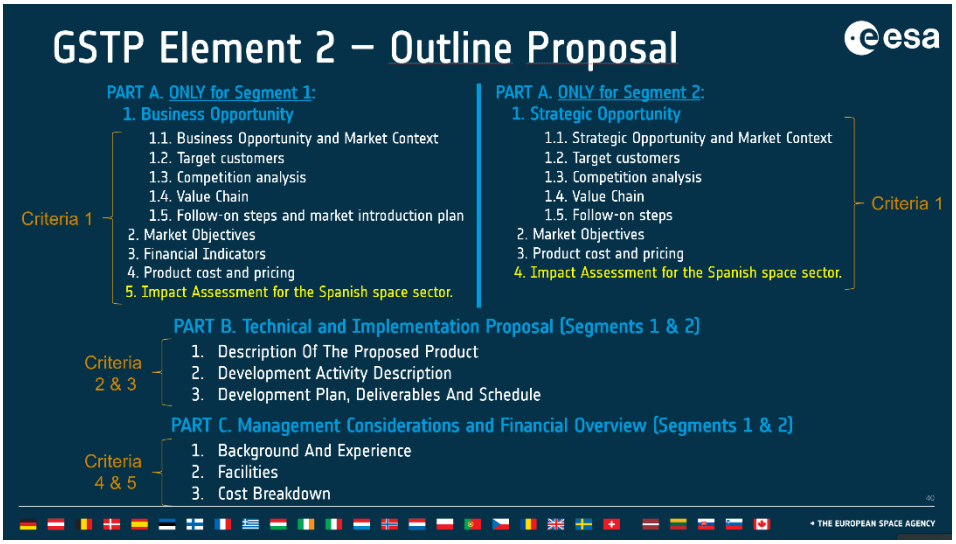
Category 2: GSTP Element 1 Building Blocks Framework - Technologies for Lunar Exploration

- Technical Proposal
- Chapter 1.1 Application(s) of the Development



Category 3: GSTP Element 2

- PART A. ONLY for Segment 1: Chapter 1. Business Opportunity
- PART A. ONLY for Segment 2: Chapter 1. Strategic Opportunity



9. Annex 3: Detailed Evaluation Criteria

GSTP Element 1 - De-Risk Framework
Criteria 1. Technical and Implementation Proposal **Clear and credible definition of the technical objectives, key requirements, technical steps, and risks to be addressed in this activity**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Key technical requirements and objectives of the **full activity** (de-risk and follow-on phases) - Technical steps and implementation of the engineering approach for the **full activity** (de-risk and follow-on phases) - Technical implementation/programme of work for the **de-risk phase**:   - Work logic/Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)   - Work package description   - Deliverables - Technology Readiness Level (TRL) and Model Philosophy - Schedule proposed - Technical, schedule and financial risks to be addressed and mitigation actions
Criteria 2. Innovation, Application and Impact assessment of the proposed development **Clear indication of the application and potential users of the technology**
Adequacy and credibility of the following: - Understanding of the state of the art and innovation of the proposed development - Application of the proposed development: - Identification of targeted future missions markets or programmes (e.g. national, ESA or commercial missions) that can benefit from the output of the present activity. - Impact Assessment for the Spanish Space Sector.
Criteria 3.1. Management Considerations **Clarity of the management approach**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Background and experience of the economic operator(s) - Facilities - Management plan, including key personnel - Long lead Items Time Impacts
Criteria 3.2. Financial Overview **Adequacy of the proposed costs with the work to be performed**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the costs breakdown and requested funding
Criteria 4. Cost to Completion **Clear information about Cost to Completion including the Follow-on activities**
- Follow-on estimated cost and total cost to completion - Further steps needed to complete the development and estimated cost per step

GSTP Element 1 – Building Blocks Framework – Technologies for Lunar Exploration
Criteria 1. Technical and Implementation Proposal **Clear and credible definition of the technical objectives, key requirements, technical steps, and risks to be addressed in this activity**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Key technical requirements and objectives of the activity - Technical steps and implementation of the engineering approach for the activity - Technical implementation/programme of work for the activity: - Work logic/Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)   - Work package description   - Deliverables - Technology Readiness Level (TRL) and Model Philosophy - Schedule proposed - Technical, schedule and financial risks to be addressed and mitigation actions
Criteria 2. Innovation, Application and Impact assessment of the proposed development **Clear indication of the application and potential users of the technology**
Adequacy and credibility of the following: - Understanding of the state of the art and innovation of the proposed development - Application of the proposed development: - Identification of targeted future missions' markets or programmes (e.g. national, ESA or commercial missions) that can benefit from the output of the present activity. - Impact assessment for the Spanish Space Sector
Criteria 3.1. Management Considerations **Clarity of the management approach**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Background and experience of the economic operator(s) - Facilities - Management plan, including key personnel - Long lead Items Time Impacts
Criteria 3.2. Financial Overview **Adequacy of the proposed costs with the work to be performed**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the proposed costs breakdown and requested funding

GSTP Element 2
PART 1. Market Context, Business/Strategic Opportunity **Clarity and credibility of the market context and business opportunity (for segment 1) or strategic opportunity (for segment 2)**
- Market Context and Business/Strategic Opportunity - Market Objectives (current market share and market share forecast) - Target customers - Competition analysis - Value Chain - Follow-on steps and market introduction plan - Financial Indicators (Return on Investment information) - Product cost and pricing - Coherence of the proposal presented with the applicant's strategic plan. - Impact Assessment for the Spanish Space Sector
PART 2. Technical Proposal **Credibility and quality of the technical requirements, technical solutions versus activity objectives**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Proposed product development - Key technical requirements and objectives of the activity - Identification of the Main Problem(s) or Problem Area(s) and proposed Risk Mitigation Actions/Solutions to the Problems identified - Technology Readiness Level (TRL) and Model Philosophy
PART 3. Implementation Proposal **Credibility and quality of the proposed development plan, deliverables and schedule**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Development plan, including the technical implementation for the activity: - Work logic/Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)   - Work package description   - Deliverables - Schedule proposed - Technical, schedule and financial risks to be addressed and mitigation actions
PART 4. Management Considerations **Credibility and quality of the bidder's background, experience and facilities**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of the following: - Background and experience of the economic operator(s) - Applicant's previous experience in other ESA projects and in the topic of the proposal - Facilities - Management plan, including key personnel - Long lead Items time impacts
PART 5. Financial Overview **Credibility and quality of the cost breakdown by major cost elements and cost by funding source**
Adequacy, credibility and clarity of proposed costs breakdown and requested funding